Math Intervention Guide | For Teachers

How to teach, track and talk about Tier 2 math intervention, and what to do when a student isn't making progress

Step 1: Plan before each session

- **Know the one target skill** for this group (for example, comparing fractions).
- **Gather your materials:** fraction strips or other manipulatives, whiteboards, the lesson and this week's progress check.
- **Pick 2–3 key math words** to pre-teach (for example, *numerator, denominator, equivalent*).

Step 2: Teach every session the same way

1 I do
Model the skill with manipulatives and think aloud: say exactly what you're thinking.

▶

2 We do
Guided practice together. Give quick, specific corrective feedback.

▶

3 You do
Students practice on their own while you watch and check.

▶

4 Explain it
Each student explains their thinking out loud or with a drawing.

Move from concrete to abstract (CRA): comparing 1/2 and 2/3

Concrete	Representational	Abstract
Line up fraction strips for 1/2 and 2/3. Which is longer?	Draw both on a number line or as bar models.	Find common denominators: 3/6 < 4/6, so 1/2 < 2/3.

Don't skip the concrete stage. If a student gets stuck with symbols, go back a step.

Step 3: Make the math accessible

- **Read word problems aloud** so reading doesn't block the math.
- **Use visuals**: drawings, number lines, labeled diagrams.
- **Post a word bank** with pictures for key math vocabulary.
- **Give sentence frames:** "___ is greater than ___ because ___."
- **Let students show it** with manipulatives or drawings before writing.
- **Keep the math on grade level.** Support the language, not easier math.

Partner with your multilingual learner specialist for students who are learning English.

Step 4: Track progress every week

- Give the **weekly progress check** on the same day each week.
- Use the **same skill at a similar difficulty** every week, so the scores can be compared.
- **Graph each score** and draw the **goal line** from the starting score to the goal.
- **Log attendance:** note every missed session and the reason.
- **Make up missed sessions** whenever you can.
- Keep **2–3 work samples** that show what the student can and can't do yet.

Step 5: Read your graph after 4–6 weeks

At or above the goal line
Keep going. Talk with your coach about when to fade support.

Below the goal line but rising
Use the checklist below. Ask your coach to observe or co-plan a session.

Flat or going down
Bring the student to the MTSS team. Don't wait for the next cycle to end.

Self-check: did I teach it as planned?

□ Session happened as scheduled (time and length)
□ Used manipulatives or visuals
□ Modeled the skill with a think-aloud
□ Guided practice with corrective feedback
□ Student explained their thinking aloud
□ Pre-taught key math vocabulary
□ Independent practice on the target skill
□ Gave this week's progress check (same skill and difficulty)

Not sure how to use the manipulatives? That's normal. Ask your coach to model a lesson.

Bring to the MTSS meeting

□ The progress graph with the goal line
□ Attendance log (missed and made-up sessions)
□ 2–3 recent work samples
□ Your notes: what helps, what's hard, where the student shuts down
□ The student's own words: what feels confusing, when they feel confident
□ The "Did I teach it as planned?" checklist (left), filled out for recent sessions

If you think a student may have a disability

- **Tell your MTSS lead or case manager right away.** Share your data and notes.
- You **don't have to finish another intervention cycle first**. MTSS cannot delay an evaluation when a disability is suspected.
- If a **parent asks for testing**, pass the request to your campus team the same day. Parents can request an evaluation at any time.
- A low score alone, or a student still learning English, is **not** a reason to refer on its own.

Remember: MTSS is for every student, including general education, emergent bilingual, 504 and special education students. It isn't a path to a special education label. It's how we match instruction to what each student needs.

Adapted from the National Center on Intensive Intervention's Data-Based Individualization (DBI) process. Designed by Yvette Saucedo, M.Ed. For training use; examples are fictional and contain no student information.